KATE GAO

Brooklyn, NY | kategao1005@gmail.com | https://kg1005.github.io/my-palettes

PROFILE

Data Science and Psychology student who turns messy, real-world data into clear, decision-ready insights. Experienced in data cleaning and validation, statistical analysis, experiment design, and AI-assisted classification using Python, SQL, and BI tools. Brings a behavioral science lens to understanding how people decide, and communicates findings to technical and non-technical audiences in English and Mandarin.

EDUCATION

New York University — New York, NY
B.A. Data Science and Psychology | **GPA:** 3.61 — May 2028
• *Relevant Coursework: Principles of Data Science I & II, Introduction to Computer Science (Java), Data Structures (Java), Linear Algebra, Calculus I, Cognition, Abnormal Psychology*
• *Certifications: Motion Creative Strategy Bootcamp; Inside LVMH Certificate (in progress); Bloomberg Market Concepts (in progress)*
• *Activities: Girls Who Code (GWC@NYU), Women in Data Science (WiDS@NYU), Quantitative Finance Society, Marketing Society*

DATA & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

NYU Wasserman Center for Career Development — Systems, Data & Assessment Team — New York, NY
Undergraduate Student Research Assistant — September 2026 – Present
- Research and verify career outcomes for ~100 graduates weekly for NYU's annual Life Beyond the Square survey.
- Cut per-graduate research time ~37% (8 to 5 minutes) by building targeted international and social media search strategies.
- Analyze outcome data in Google Sheets to identify trends, flagging 20–30 incomplete records for data quality review.

Handshake AI — Remote
AI Trainer & Evaluator (Contract) — Incoming, November 2026
- Selected for 2 contract projects evaluating AI model outputs for accuracy across audio, visual, and text tasks.

Institute for Basic Research Laboratory (IBR) — Staten Island, NY
Student Researcher — June 2022 – June 2024
- Quantified PV+ neurons across 16 brain regions using StereoInvestigator, finding up to 50% fewer in injured tissue.
- Ran t-tests and standard deviation analysis in Google Sheets; diagnosed an outlier traced to counting-frame placement.
- Co-authored a 17-page research paper on traumatic brain injury and epilepsy; presented findings to research cohort.

DATA SCIENCE & ANALYTICS PROJECTS

Retail Promotion Intelligence | Python, SQL, Excel Power Query, Power BI, Excel
Independent Data Analytics Project — In Progress
- Building a promotion decision-support prototype from 541,909 retail transactions using Python, SQL, and Power BI.
- Segmenting customers by recency, frequency, and spend (RFM) to identify purchasing trends and target promotions.
- Designing A/B tests for 3 customer segments, pairing behavior-informed promotions with success and guardrail metrics.

Obsession 2025 Movie Review Lens | Python, ChatGPT, Claude, Codex, JavaScript, Plotly.js
Independent Data Science & AI Project — In Progress
- Designing an AI-assisted sentiment study of ~100 audience reactions, comparing pre-release trailer comments with post-release reviews.
- Translated 3 psychology constructs into an AI classification codebook requiring structured outputs and evidence phrases.
- Designing a validation test comparing AI labels against 25 manual codes to measure agreement and identify error patterns.

My Palettes | HTML, CSS, JavaScript
Personal Portfolio Site — In Progress
- Built and maintain a personal website showcasing data science projects and visual design work.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNICATION

Baedeker Magazine — New York, NY
Outreach Head & Designer — March 2025 – Present
- Promoted to Outreach Head after 2 semesters; secured 25% of sponsorships (4 of 16), converting 50% of prospects.
- Managed sponsor and speaker relationships via email, securing Neutrogena raffle gifts, catering, and guest speakers.
- Designed 2 published magazine spreads, balancing writers' and photographers' creative visions.

Maimonides Hospital — Brooklyn, NY
Lead Health Scholar — July 2023 – October 2024
- Supported 5–10 patients per shift, facilitating Mandarin-English communication with clinicians tailored to each patient's needs.
- Collaborated with nurses and technicians to improve patient comfort, confirming dietary restrictions before providing meals.

GOAL Family Medical P.C. — Lynbrook, NY
Media Specialist Intern — July 2024 – Aug 2024
- Wrote biweekly newsletters translating complex medical treatments into accessible language; improved website from a user's perspective.

SKILLS

Programming: Python (Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Seaborn), SQL, Java, JavaScript, HTML, CSS
Data Analysis & Statistics: Data Cleaning & Validation, Exploratory Data Analysis, Hypothesis Testing, t-tests, Customer Segmentation (RFM), A/B Test Design, Experimentation, Sentiment Analysis
Visualization & BI: Power BI, Dashboards, Plotly, Streamlit, Excel, Excel Power Query, Google Sheets
AI Tools: ChatGPT, Claude, Codex, AI-Assisted Classification, AI Model Evaluation, Prompt Design
Tools: Jupyter, VS Code, Git, GitHub, Microsoft Office (PowerPoint, Word, Outlook)
Research & Communication: Survey Design, Research Documentation, Data Storytelling, Presentations, Stakeholder Management
Languages: English (Fluent), Mandarin (Fluent)
Interests: Behavioral Science, Landscape Photography, Sketching, Reading Novels